

Personality Science From the Person to the Population

Emorie D. Beck, Ph.D.

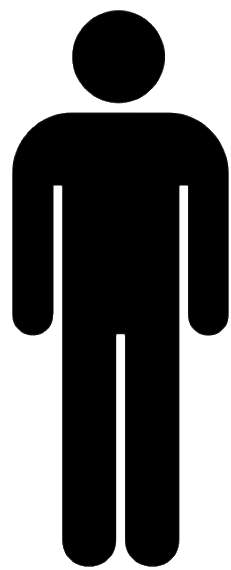
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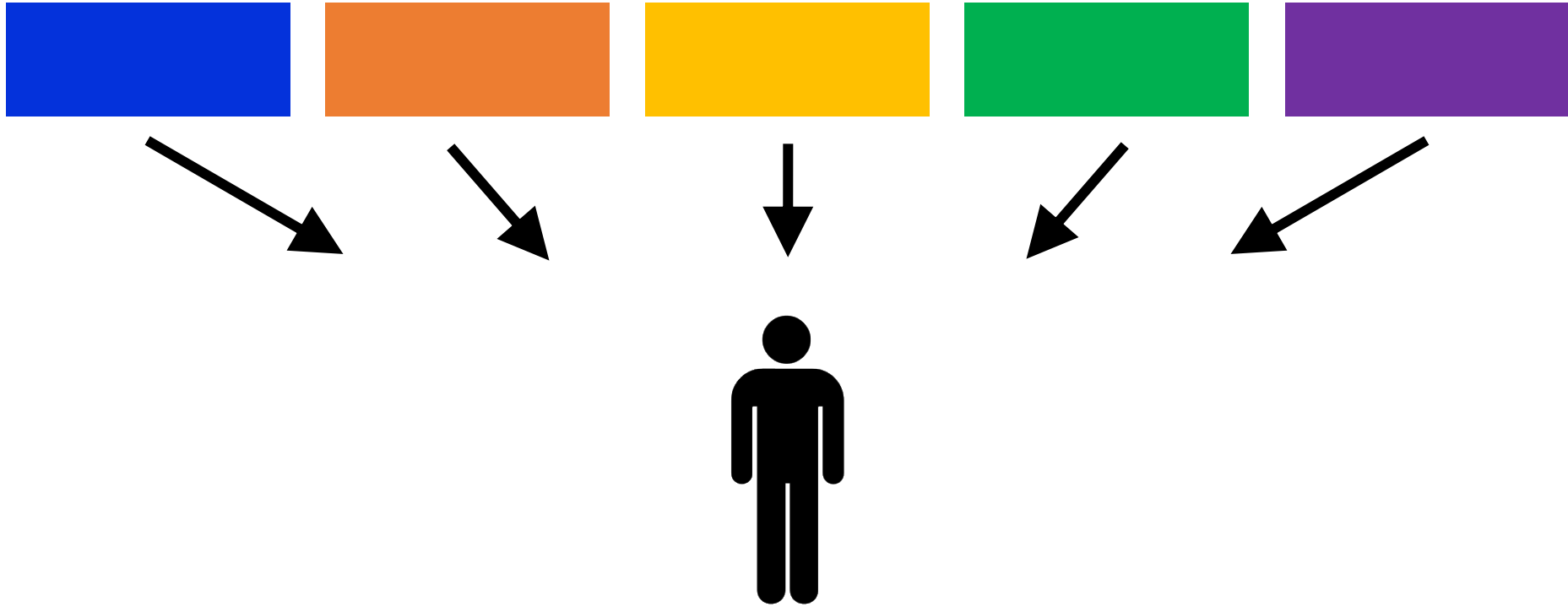
@EmorieBeck

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Nomothetic
Between-Person
Variable Centered



Idiographic
Person-Specific
N=1

Goals and Tools in Psychology

Goals

Describe

Predict

Explain

Scope

All people

Some people

One Person

Tools

Theories

Research Design

Assessment

Statistical Models

Goals and Tools in Psychology

Goals

Scope

Tools

**Challenge: Research questions
have to be aligned to the goals,
scope, and tools**

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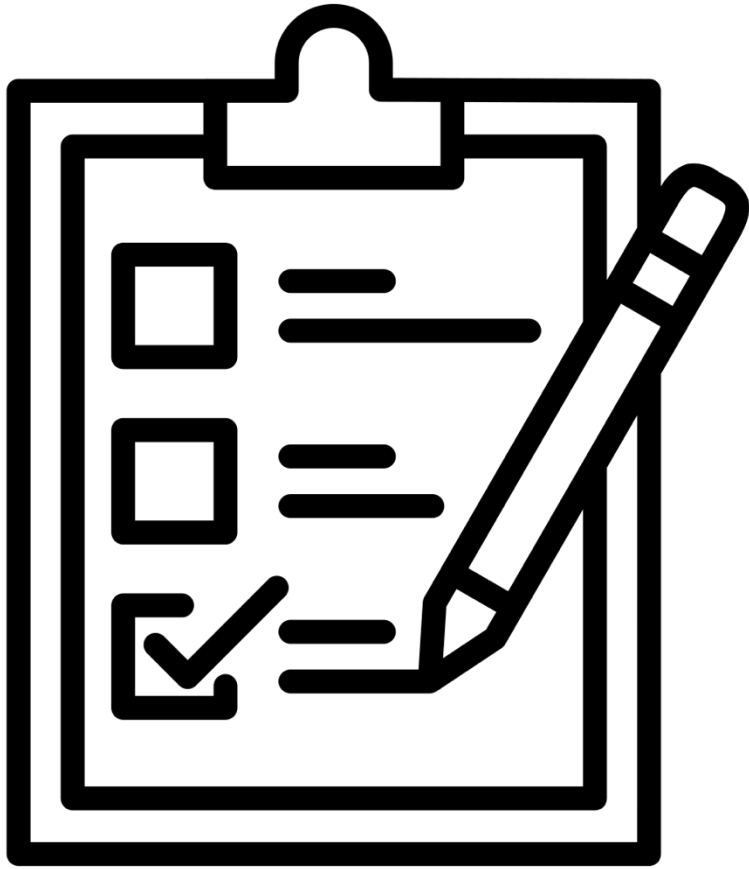
Theories

Research Design

Assessment

Statistical Models

Pragmatic Constraints on $N = 1$ Research



Large-scale surveys



In lab experiments

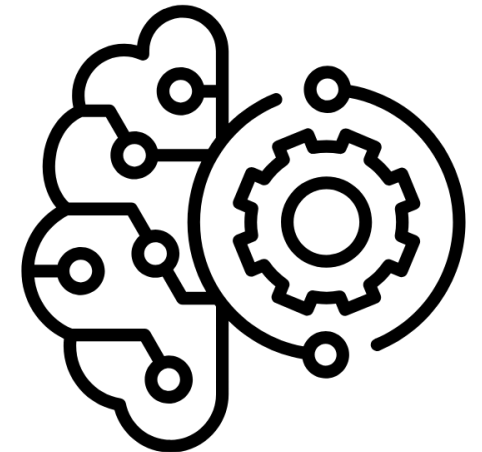
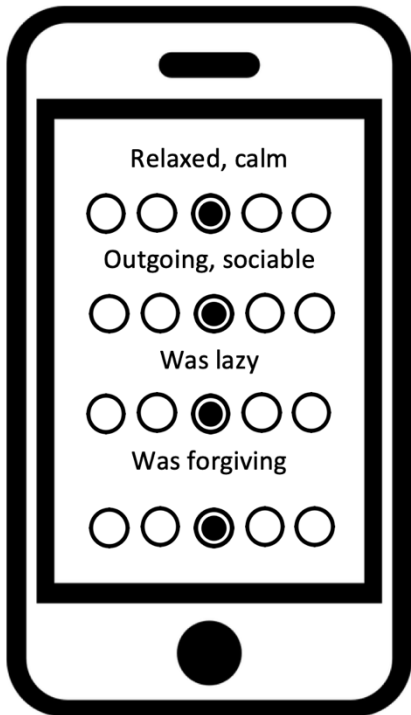
Modern Opportunities for $N = 1$ Research

ESM / EMA

Mobile Sensing

Open-Ended
Responses

AI / NLP



Goals and Tools in Psychology

Goals

Scope

Tools

It's time to start fully utilizing the goals, scope, and tools available for psychological research to build an integrative psychological science.

es

Design

ment

Models

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Bottom-Up Psychological Science

Instead of growing impatient with the single case and hastening on to generalization, why should we not grow impatient with our generalizations and hasten to the internal pattern?" (Allport, 1961, p. 84)

Tools

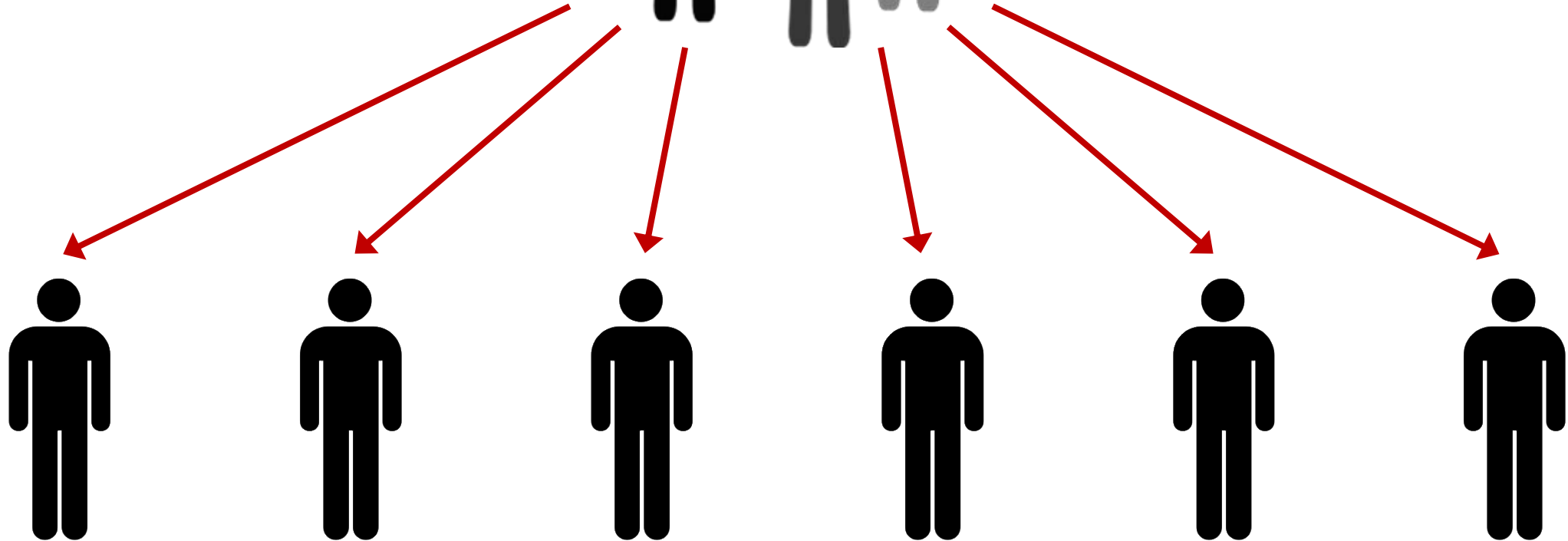
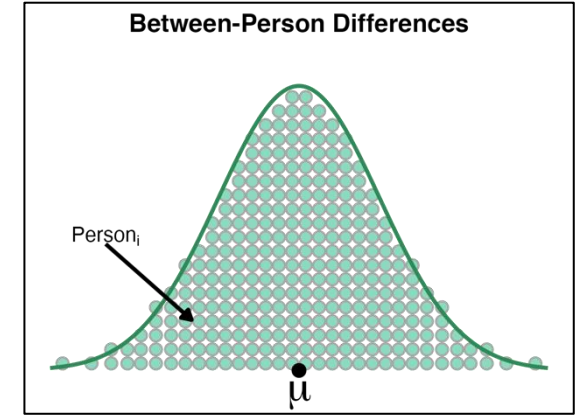
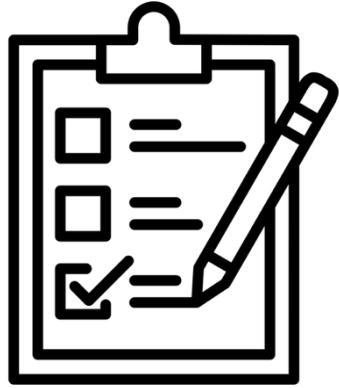
Theories

Research Design

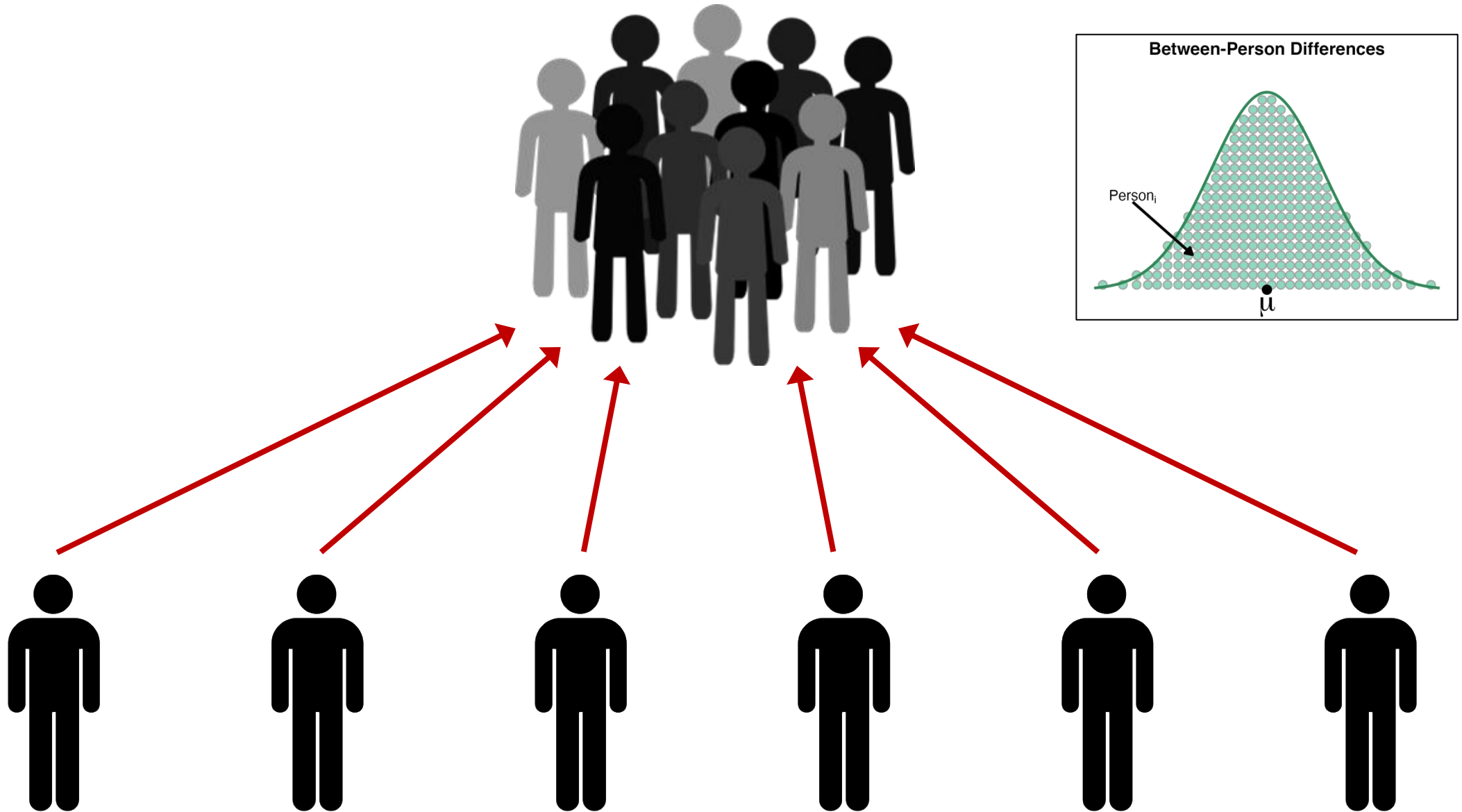
Assessment

Statistical Models

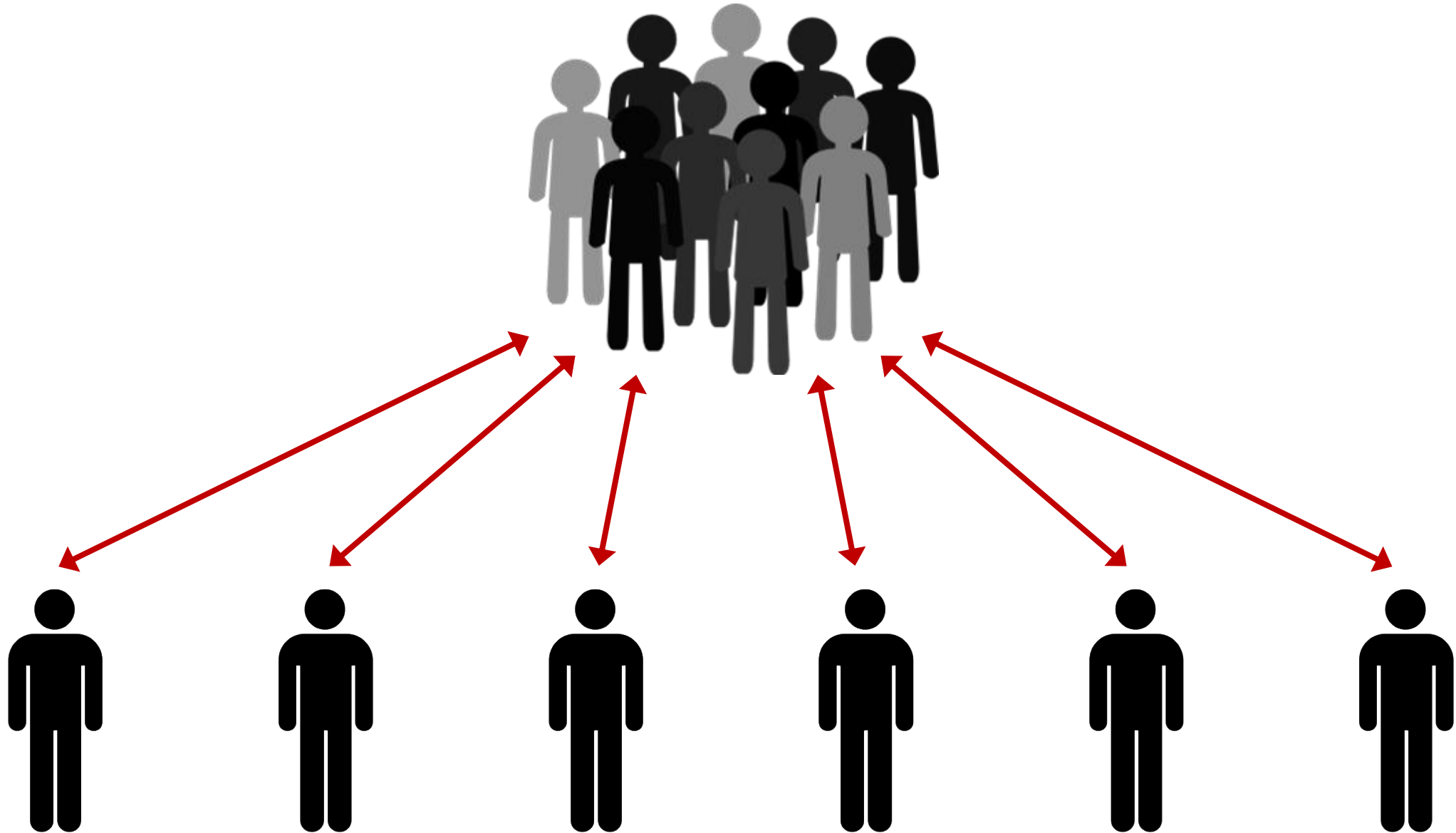
Top-Down Psychological Science



Bottom-Up Psychological Science



Bottom-Up Psychological Science



Goals and Tools in Psychology

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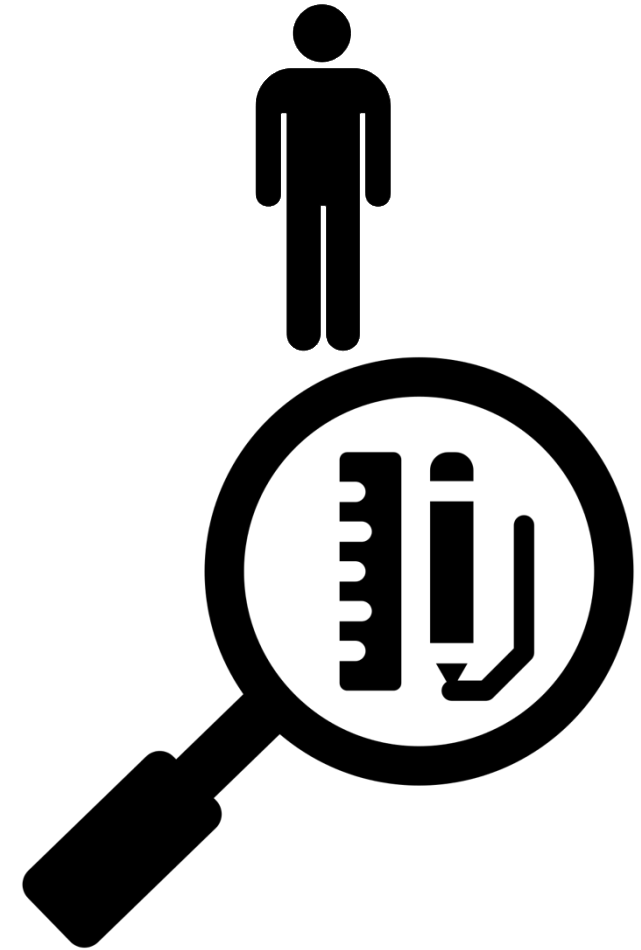
Assessment

Statistical Models

Bottom-Up Psychological Theories

***For whom* do different theories apply?**

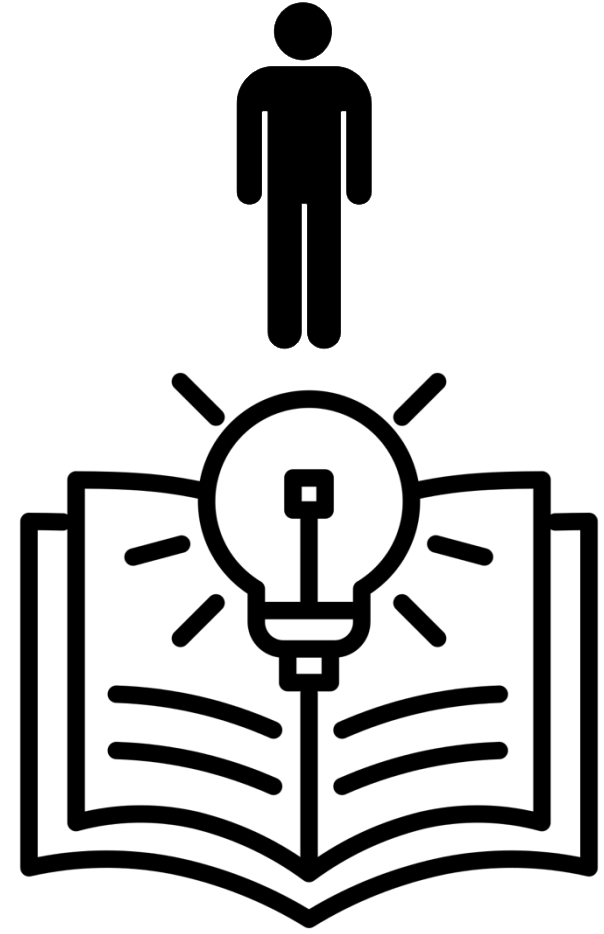
Novel theory generation by starting with the single case (repeated many times)



Bottom-Up Psychological Research Designs

$N = 1$ clinical trials and experiments

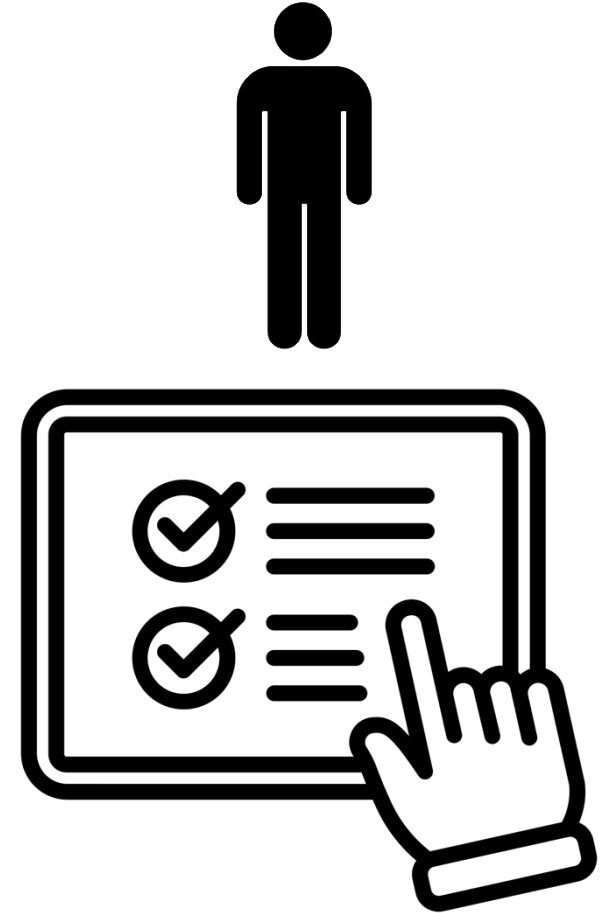
**Leveraging multiple timescales
(e.g., measurement burst
designs, mini bursts, random
intervals)**



Bottom-Up Psychological Assessment

Personalized assessment

**Utilizing mixed methods
approaches**



The Personalizing Personality Pilot Study

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 N = 200

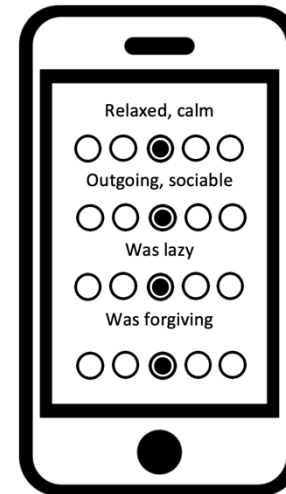


Study Design



Baseline Surveys

- Big Five Personality
- Cardinal Traits
- Demographics
- **Unique Item Generation**
- ...
- etc.



Experience Sampling Method (ESM)

5 x / day for 3 weeks (max n = 105)

- Big Five Personality States
- Unique, participant generated “Cardinal States”
- DIAMONDS Situation Characteristics
- Binary Behavior Indicators
- Passive Sensing

The Personalizing Personality Pilot Study

Study Design

UC DAVIS



Preliminary results suggest that unique, cardinal states capture unique content, have less restricted range, and are frequently top predictors of momentary outcomes

- Binary Behavior Indicators
- Passive Sensing

MATERIALS

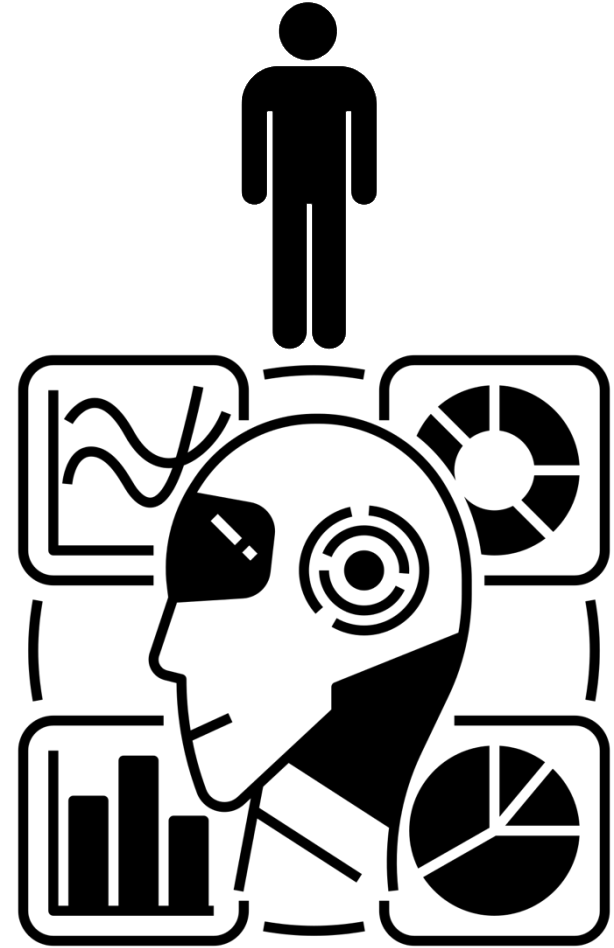
= 105)

eristics

Bottom-Up Psychological Statistical Models

Information sharing

Formal Modeling



Interim Summary

Changing the scope of analysis doesn't magically realign research questions with theories and methods

Utilizing novel tools provides new opportunities to bring alignment

Bottom-up approaches that put a person in context offers a framework for capturing heterogeneity and generalizability

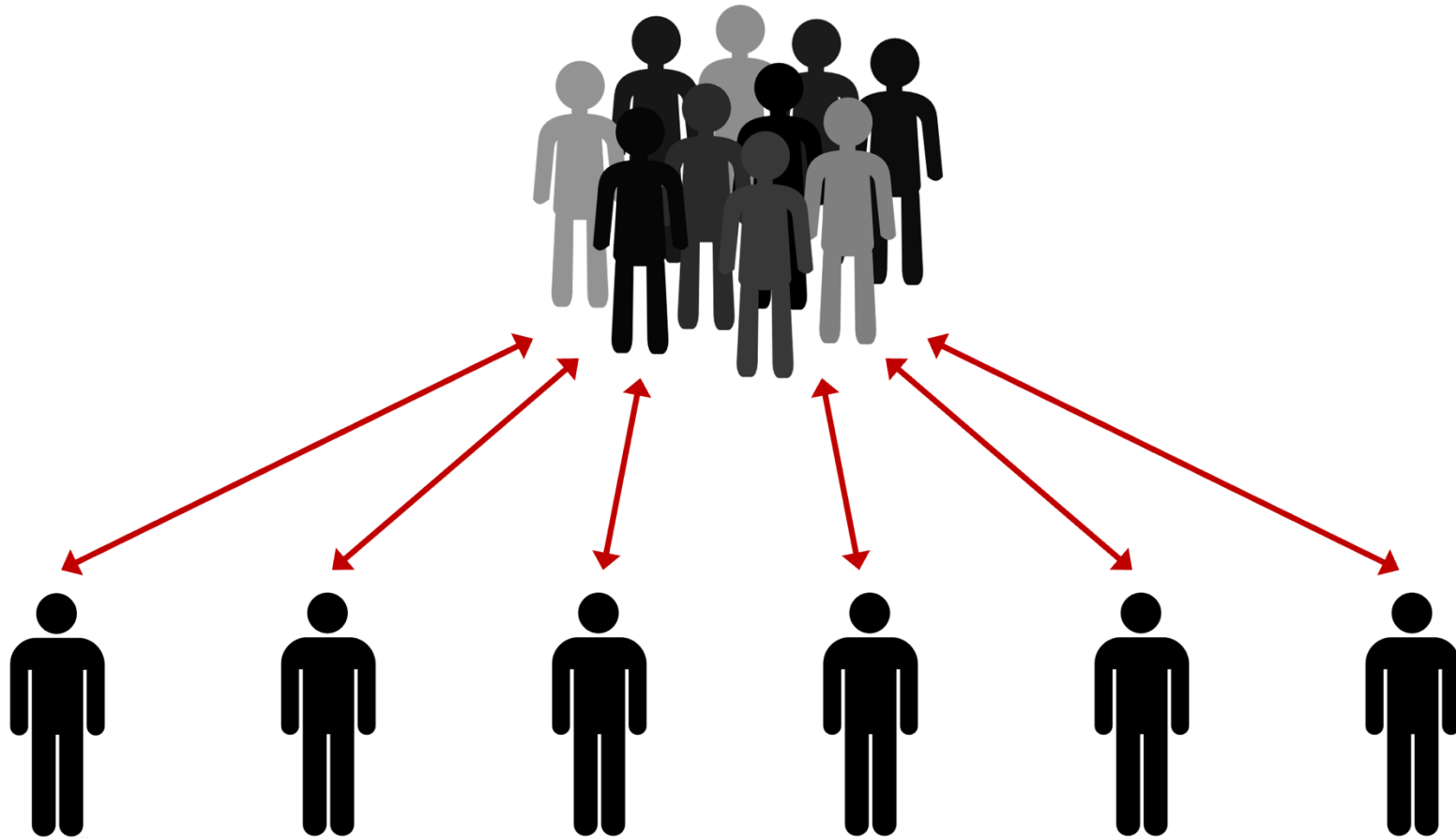
Introducing PECORINO

Personality Consortium on Research in Idiographics and Nomothetics

- **Mission statement:** PECORINO is dedicated to advancing the field of personality science by bridging the gap between the study of individual persons and the exploration of general laws of personality functioning. Our mission is to integrate idiographic and nomothetic approaches to create a more comprehensive understanding of personality.

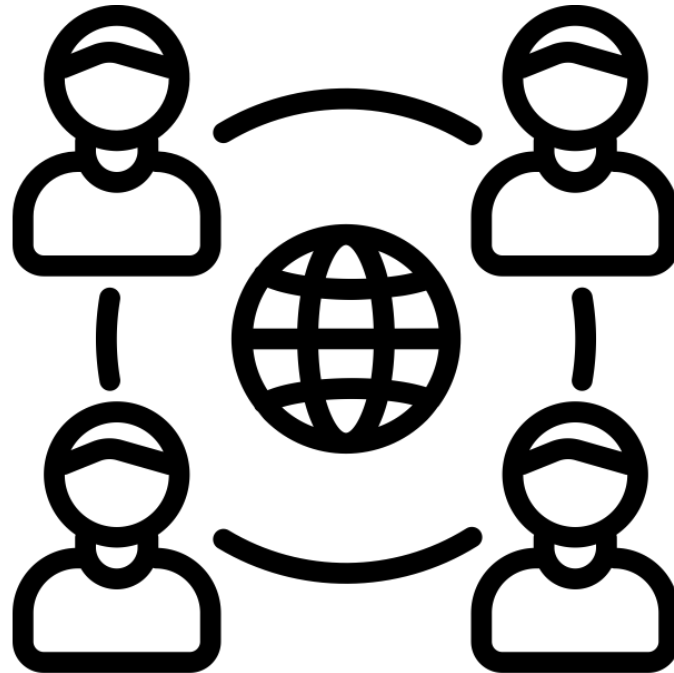
Introducing PECORINO: Goals and Purpose

1. Advancing Integrated Research



Introducing PECORINO: Goals and Purpose

- 1. Advancing Integrated Research**
- 2. Fostering a Global Community**



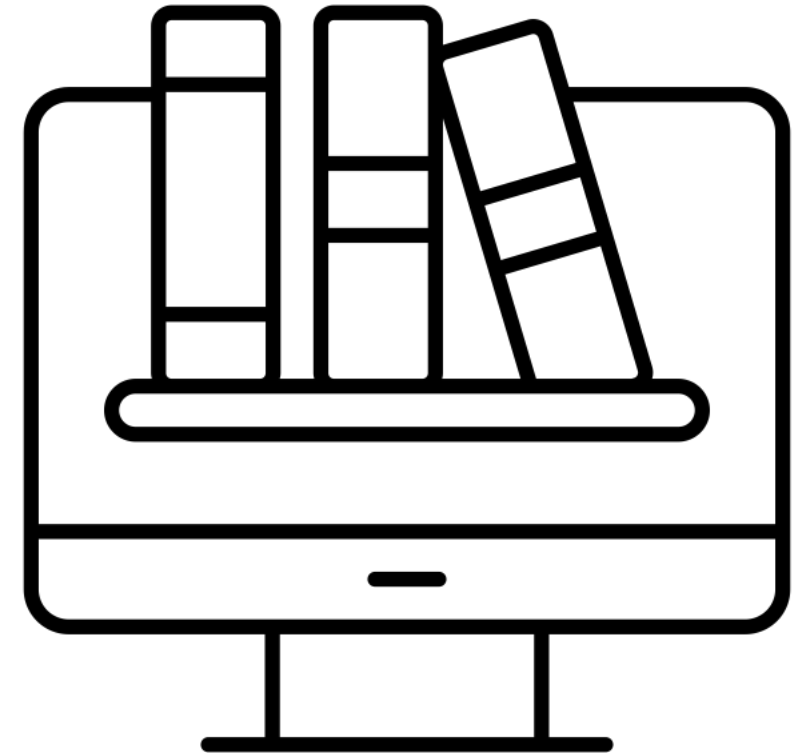
Introducing PECORINO: Goals and Purpose

- 1. Advancing Integrated Research**
- 2. Fostering a Global Community**
- 3. Promoting Conceptual Clarity**



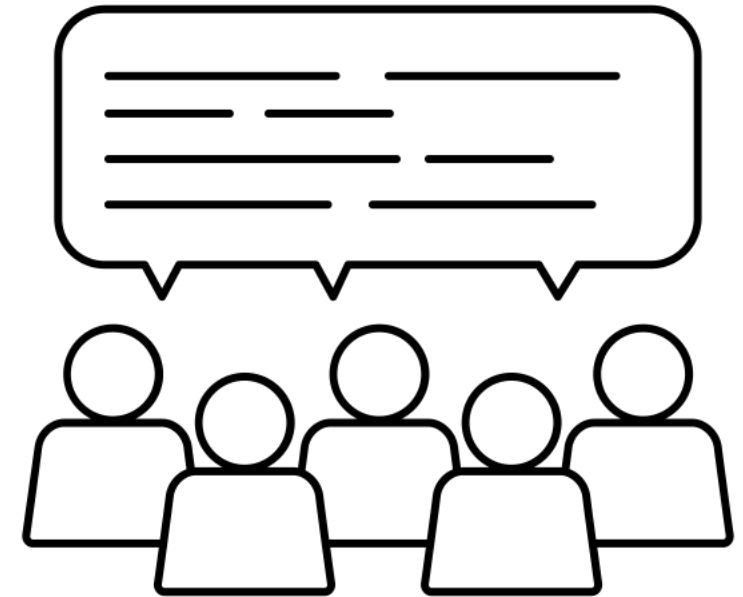
Introducing PECORINO: Goals and Purpose

- 1. Advancing Integrated Research**
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- 3. Promoting Conceptual Clarity**
- 4. Providing Educational Resources**



Introducing PECORINO: Goals and Purpose

- 1. Advancing Integrated Research**
- 2. Fostering a Global Community**
- 3. Promoting Conceptual Clarity**
- 4. Providing Educational Resources**
- 5. Organizing meetings**



Introducing PECORINO: Organization

President: Emorie Beck

Vice President: Charlie Renner

Organizational Team:

**Niclas Kuper
Nick Modersitzki
Le Vy Phan
John Rauthmann**

Current Members (alphabetical):

Pia Andresen
Nadin Beckmann
Giulio Costantini
Egon Dejonckheere
Małgosia Fajkowska
Aaron Fisher
Mario Gollwitzer
Ellen Hamaker
Kai Horstmann
Niclas Kuper
Suzanne McDonald
Nick Modersitzki
Le Vy Phan
Markus Quirin
John Rauthmann
Aidan Wright
Johannes Zimmermann

Introducing PECORINO: Get Involved!

Mailing List

pecorino_group@googlegroups.com

Contact Us

pecorino.consortium@gmail.com

Website

<http://pecorinoconsortium.wixsite.com/pecorino>

The consortium emerged out of an expert meeting and pre-conference on the topic “Dynamics of Personality: Integrating Nomothetic and Idiographic Approaches into a Synthetic Framework” funded by the European Association of Personality Psychology and organized by Niclas Kuper, Nick Modersitzki, Le Vy Phan, Markus Quirin, and John Rauthmann.

Thank you!

Related Symposia

Murray-Helson Award Symposium, Fri, 1:15-2:30 PM (Chair: Bill Chopik)

Applied Narrative Psychology, Fri, 2:45-4 PM (Chair: Nic M. Weststrate)

Personality Dynamics: From Theory to Practice, Fri, 4:15-5:30 PM (Chair: Muchen Xi)

Characterizing Mental and Physical Health across Contexts, Fri, 4:15-5:30 PM (Chair: Courtland Hyatt)

Innovative Methodologies for the Study of Person-situation Dynamics, Sat, 2:30-3:45 (Chair: Anabel Büchner)

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The Beck Lab



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